

VS**ValuSignal 2026**

● APPRAISER GUIDE

UAD 3.6

A Practical Appraiser's Guide

A no-fluff guide to navigating UAD 3.6 — from common review failures to defensible reporting strategies you can apply immediately.

01**What Changed**

Field-by-field breakdown of the new requirements.

02**Where Reports Fail**

The most common rejection triggers and how to avoid them.

03**Adjust Your Workflow**

Templates, checklists, and process tweaks that stick.

NOV**02****2026****Mandatory Date**

Starting November 2, 2026, all GSE-bound appraisals must use UAD 3.6. The Broad Production window is open now — use it to stabilize your workflow before the hard deadline.

What Changed in UAD 3.6

A field-by-field breakdown of what is new, what is restructured, and what it means for your reports.

Key Rollout Dates

DATE	PHASE	WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU
Sep 2025 – Jan 2026	Limited Production	Select participants testing the new format.
Jan 2026 – Nov 1, 2026	Broad Production	UAD 3.6 submissions accepted. Early adopters stabilizing workflows.
Nov 2, 2026	MANDATORY	All new GSE-bound submissions must use UAD 3.6. This is the line.
May 3, 2027	UAD 2.6 Retired	Pipeline revisions on old format no longer accepted.

Field-by-Field: What Is New or Restructured

SECTION / FIELD	CHANGE TYPE	WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICE
Dynamic URAR	<i>Replaces Form 1004/70 and legacy layouts</i>	One adaptive form. Sections appear or hide based on property type and assignment scope. Every visible section must be complete.
Structured Data Fields	<i>Standardized pick-lists replace free-text</i>	Condition (C1–C6), Quality (Q1–Q6), site data, and market fields now use validated pick-lists. Automated cross-checks flag contradictions between selected values and written comments.
Market Conditions Section	<i>More defined trend inputs required</i>	Supply/demand direction, absorption rate, and marketing time fields must be filled explicitly. Leaving checkboxes blank or inconsistent with your written analysis is a common SSR flag.
"Additional Properties	<i>New required table</i>	Every comp you considered and screened out must be logged here with: address, sale date/status, Reason Not

SECTION / FIELD	CHANGE TYPE	WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICE
Analyzed Not Used"		Used, and a brief comment. This is what makes ROV responses transparent and auditable.
Section 5: Disaster Mitigation	<i>New structured section</i>	Pick-list capture for roof ratings, impact-resistant materials, flood mitigation, wildfire defensible space. If none apply, state it explicitly — do not skip the section.
Section 6: Energy Efficient & Green Features	<i>New structured section</i>	Standardized fields for solar (owned/leased/PPA), HVAC specs, insulation, certifications (HERS, ENERGY STAR), and water heater type. Market impact still requires comp support — documentation alone is not enough.
Submission Summary Report (SSR)	<i>Revised feedback structure</i>	Error flags now map to specific URAR sections and subsections. Expect more precise "resolve this item in Section X" requests instead of general revision notes.
Comparable Sales Grid	<i>Tighter data validation</i>	Distance, date, and data-field inputs are cross-validated automatically. Outliers that passed manual review under UAD 2.6 will now trigger SSR flags.

KEY POINT The biggest structural shift is automated cross-validation. UAD 3.6 checks your inputs against each other. A C3 rating with comments describing deferred maintenance issues will get flagged automatically — something that passed manual review under UAD 2.6.

Where Reports Fail Review

The most common rejection triggers under UAD 3.6 — and what to check before submission.

01

C/Q Rating Contradicts Written Comments

The most flagged issue. A C3 rating assigned while comments describe “average condition with no deferred maintenance” is an automatic cross-validation fail. Write comments that directly support the assigned rating — every time.

Fix: Before finalizing, read your C/Q rating and your comments side-by-side. They must tell the same story.

02

“Additional Properties Analyzed” Table Left Empty

Reviewers and underwriters now expect this table to be populated. An empty table signals either that you did not screen any comps (unlikely) or that you skipped documenting your selection process.

Fix: Log every comp you pulled and rejected, even briefly. “Outside market area — 2.1 mi” is sufficient.

03

Market Conditions Checkboxes Blank or Contradictory

Supply/demand and trend direction fields left blank will trigger SSR flags. Worse: checking “Declining” supply while writing “stable market conditions” in comments creates a contradiction the automated validator will catch.

Fix: Fill every checkbox in the Market Conditions section. Cross-check your written narrative matches your selected values.

04

Green/Energy Features Present but Section 6 Minimal

Solar panels visible on the subject, HVAC upgrade noted in MLS, or ENERGY STAR certification on file — but Section 6 is left at defaults. Reviewers and underwriters will flag the mismatch.

Fix: If any energy feature exists, populate Section 6 completely. Ownership type (owned/leased/PPA) is required for solar.

05

Section 5 Skipped in Affected Markets

In wildfire zones, coastal flood areas, or markets with impact-resistant building standards, Section 5 is expected. Skipping it in these markets raises a question about whether features were observed.

Fix: In affected markets, either document features or explicitly state “No disaster mitigation features observed.”

06

GLA Inconsistency Not Addressed

Subject GLA differs from public records and no explanation is provided. Under UAD 3.6 structured fields, this discrepancy is flagged automatically.

Fix: Pull public records GLA before the inspection. If there is a discrepancy, document the source of your measurement and why it differs.

07

Concession Fields Incomplete

The structured concession section requires explicit entries — amount, type, and what they cover. Leaving concession fields at defaults when a contract shows credits or repairs is a common data inconsistency flag.

Fix: Transfer all concession details from the contract into the structured fields. Do not rely on comments alone.

08

Comparable Distance or Date Outliers Not Justified

Automated validation now flags comps outside typical distance or recency thresholds. These used to pass manual review if the appraiser made a general statement about limited sales activity.

Fix: Add a specific, market-supported justification for each outlier comp in the new comments field linked to that comparable.

PATTERN The common thread in failed reviews: structured fields and written narrative tell different stories. UAD 3.6 automated validation makes these contradictions visible immediately. Internal consistency is now a technical requirement, not just a best practice.

How to Adjust Your Workflow

Templates, checklists, and process tweaks that stick — organized by stage of the assignment.

Stage 1 — Before the Inspection

- ☐ Confirm whether the AMC/lender is submitting UAD 3.6 or still on 2.6. Your workflow differs.
- ☐ Pull public records GLA and note any discrepancy before you arrive.
- ☐ Review MLS (public + private remarks) for green features, recent upgrades, and solar notes.
- ☐ Check property location for wildfire, flood, or coastal zone status (Section 5 preparation).
- ☐ Request upgrade documentation from the agent if MLS mentions HVAC, solar, or energy improvements.

Stage 2 — At the Inspection

- ☐ Photograph condition items that will inform your C/Q rating selection.
- ☐ Document solar: ownership type (owned/leased/PPA), system size (kW), install date, inverter/battery.
- ☐ Document HVAC: system type, efficiency rating, install date.
- ☐ Note insulation type, window type/year, water heater type.
- ☐ Document any certifications on-site: HERS, ENERGY STAR placard, utility agreements.
- ☐ Note disaster mitigation features if present: roof rating, impact-resistant materials, flood barriers.

Stage 3 — Writing the Report

- ☐ C/Q ratings: write comments that directly and explicitly support the assigned rating. Read them side-by-side before saving.
- ☐ Market Conditions: fill ALL structured trend fields. Do not leave supply/demand checkboxes blank.
- ☐ Verify your written market narrative matches your selected checkbox values.
- ☐ "Additional Properties Analyzed Not Used": log every comp screened out, with address and brief reason.
- ☐ Section 5 (Disaster Mitigation): populate if applicable, or note "None observed" explicitly.
- ☐ Section 6 (Green Features): populate all applicable fields. Solar ownership type is required.
- ☐ Concessions: fill all structured fields from the contract. Do not rely on comments alone.
- ☐ Outlier comps (distance/date): add specific justification in the linked comments field.

- ☐ GLA: if different from public records, document measurement source and reason.

Stage 4 — Before You Submit

- ☐ Run your internal QC against the common SSR triggers listed in Section 2 of this guide.
- ☐ Verify all structured sections are complete — no required fields left at defaults.
- ☐ Cross-check: does every pick-list selection match the supporting narrative in comments?
- ☐ Review “Additional Properties Analyzed Not Used” table: does it reflect your full selection process?
- ☐ Check Section 5 and Section 6 for completeness relative to observed features.

ROV Request Template (UAD 3.6-Aware)

Use this structure when submitting a reconsideration of value. UAD 3.6’s “Additional Properties Analyzed Not Used” table makes ROV outcomes more transparent — check it before submitting.

✉ ROV REQUEST TEMPLATE

Subject: Reconsideration of Value Request – [Property Address] (UAD 3.6)

Please review the attached documentation. We are requesting consideration of:

- 1. Factual corrections:** [Specific detail] supported by [permit / receipt / photo / solar agreement / measurement record].
- 2. Additional market support:** The attached transactions at [addresses] reflect [same neighborhood tier / similar GLA / similar quality / similar energy features].

Key similarities: [bullet point] — Key differences and explanation: [bullet point]

Note: Please check whether any suggested transactions are already listed in the “Additional Properties Analyzed Not Used” table. If they are included with a stated reason, we will address that reason directly. If not listed, we request they be evaluated and documented with the reason and a brief comment. Supporting documentation is attached.

ROV RULE Check the “Additional Properties Analyzed Not Used” table before submitting. If your suggested comp is already there with a reason, address that reason specifically. If it is not listed, request it be evaluated. Keep every ROV to 2–5 comps maximum.

Workflow Tweaks Worth Building Into Your Practice

Build a UAD 3.6 field checklist for your specific software.

NightHawk, Appraise-It Pro, TOTAL, and Freedom Appraise each have different interfaces for the new sections. A software-specific checklist prevents skipped fields.

Create a standard “documentation request” email to send agents.

One email covering: upgrade receipts, solar agreements, HVAC specs, certification documents. Send it at engagement, not at inspection.

Add a Section 5/6 review step to your QC process.

After writing the report but before submission: open Section 5 and Section 6, verify they match your inspection notes.

Keep a simple log of your “Additional Properties Analyzed” pulls.

A quick note during comp selection — address, pull date, reason rejected — takes 30 seconds and fills the table accurately.

ValuSignal 2026 — UAD 3.6 Deep Dive

A full session track designed for working appraisers — from compliance readiness to defensible reporting strategies.

- UAD 3.6 Field-by-Field Walkthrough
- Common Review Failures & How to Avoid Them
- Workflow Templates & Checklists
- ROV Strategies Under the New Structure
- Green Feature Documentation in Practice
- Live Q&A with UAD Compliance Experts

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